

MC2002 – Advertising and Consumer Culture: Creative Advert

The premise of the following campaign for *Rhode Beauty* (Est. 2020) aims to enlighten and build sentiment within the consumer base through promotion of wellbeing, a concept dear to founder, Hailey Bieber. Through the establishment of a connection that transcends brand-consumer, this should drive engagement through establishing brand loyalty.

The campaign aims to run for a total of 4 months broken down into three stages:

- Pre-Campaign: Months 1 – 2
- Campaign Rollout: Months 2-3
- Post Campaign: Months 3-4

Components of the creative solution comprise of: Production of “hero campaign” (applicable to multiple social media platforms), Posters/Flyers to be distributed amongst consumer dense cities and User Driven Engagement promotion.

Strengths

Rhode benefits from leveraging Hailey Bieber’s global influence and alignment with the minimalist “clean girl” aesthetic, offering authentic connection with its target audience. The established product line focuses on effective formulations that provide multipurpose functions that align with “skiminalism” (Vogue, 2021), appealing to Gen-Z and Millennials. The brands dermatologist-approved, vegan and cruelty-free formulations cater to the demand for ethical and effective skincare.

Social Media marketing has proven to be one of Rhode’s strongest attributes, utilizing platforms such as Instagram and TikTok to generate viral engagement and amplify consumer reach. Rhode positions itself as an affordable luxury, delivering premium quality products at accessible prices which creates a compelling proposition to consumers.

Weaknesses

The brands reliance on Hailey Bieber as a driving persona creates vulnerability as the foundation of Rhode is closely tied to her public image (Ojambf, 2022). Rhodes limited product range restricts its ability to address diverse skincare needs and streamline consumers purchase patterns and hinder consumer retention. Rhode also faces scepticism and challenges with establishing long term credibility as a relatively new competitor within the skincare and beauty market, this, paired with facing established competitors within the clean-minimalist beauty niche such as Glossier and Drunk Elephant highlight potential weaknesses in its position and growth trajectory.

Opportunities

Rhode bodes significant growth potential through product line expansion with complementary items such as cleansers, sunscreens and hybrid skincare-makeup products which allows for streamlining of consumers purchasing to one brand and enhancing brand loyalty; studies show that ~62% of surveyors use 1-2 brands in their daily skincare routines (Refer to figure 1.1)

Base: 1,654 internet users aged 16+ who use facial skincare products as part of their facial skincare routine

	All
Sample	1654
1-2 brands	62%
3-5 brands	29%
6-9 brands	5%
10+ brands	1%
Don't know	3%

Figure 1.1: Property of *Mintel*, 2024

Collaborations with notable figures within the social media space, designers or complementary brands may generate buzz and extend its reach into further markets. Opportunities for growth are presented within the following markets: Asia, Europe and Australasia as demand for celebrity backed brands and clean beauty products rises (Petruzzi, 2024). Leaning into sustainability initiatives such as refillable packaging, similar to that of competitors like Drunk Elephant, and carbon neutral practices could further enhance appeal for eco-conscious consumers. Potential to further consumer engagement and loyalty may be driven through community driven marketing with concepts such as ambassador programs and user generated content campaigns.

Threats

The skincare market's saturation poses a significant challenge, with Rhode competing against both legacy brands and indie disruptors. Economic uncertainty and sociopolitical climates may also affect consumer spending on premium beauty products, regardless of how "accessible" they may be, leaving Rhode vulnerable to diverted consumer spending. Being tied to Hailey Bieber's public image, as stated,

poses threats towards the brands public perception and may leave the brand vulnerable. Public perception may also be affected by shifting beauty trends and scepticism around clean beauty with concerns regarding efficacy and shelf life; which highlights the importance of maintaining innovation and transparency to maintain consumer loyalty and market relevance.

Core Message and Storytelling

“What makes you glow?” centres itself around the everyday moments that light individuals up inside. Hailey Bieber will kick off the campaign by sharing her own personal “glow moments” whether this be with her husband Justin Bieber or Father, Alec Baldwin; leveraging her connections with notable figures within the industry that may connect with younger audiences, whilst connecting these to her Rhode Products.

This Storytelling aims to set the tone for the campaign, encouraging consumers and influencers to share their own “glow stories”; creating community driven narratives that celebrate authenticity and individuality.

Product Focus

The campaign will shift focus towards Rhodes hydrating barrier-repairing products; The Peptide Glazing Fluid and Barrier Restore Cream – as essentials for achieving a radiant, glowing complexion. These products will be framed as tools that prepare and enhance your natural beauty, allowing you to truly embrace your “glow” on your best and worst days. The creation of limited edition “Glow Kits” will be introduced, packaged in a new minimalist skincare pouch in line with refined aesthetic; the curated product bundles and exclusive packaging will be directly inspired by the campaigns theme.

Social Media and User Engagement

Playing a pivotal role in the success of the campaign is user engagement on social media platforms (Statista, 2024). Customers and influencers will be encouraged to share their personal “glow” stories, in hopes that these communicate sentiment in association with the brand with bigger creators participating in the trend and broadcasting to their respective followings. These stories would be shared under the hashtag #WhatMakesYouGlow, tagging Rhode to enter giveaways or be featured on the brands platforms through inclusion in promotional material, campaign material or reposts. Interactive elements such as Instagram polls, TikTok trends and filters that simulate the Rhode “glazed” look, will further amplify participation and user engagement with the brand.

Experiential Marketing

Pop-up events in major cities will immerse consumers in the campaign, recreating similar campaigns that have proven successful for the Lip Case and Peptide Lip Treatment, events that took place in major cities such as: London, New York, Los Angeles, Paris and Toronto. The Pop-ups are to offer mini facials, interactive installations and opportunities to reflect on “What Makes You Glow”. Virtual glow workshops will be held by Hailey herself with the guidance of skincare professionals, in hopes to educate participants on achieving radiant skin whilst connecting to the idea of glow to self-care and confidence.

Outreach to social media influencers with notable say in the skincare and beauty market would take them on a singular all-inclusive brand trip, similar to that of Tarte, but with focus on including a variety of creators from various backgrounds to combat the stigma against white creator focused trips sponsored by brands, a controversy we saw from *Tarte* in 2022 (Rolling Stone, 2024).

Emotional and Social Impact

To deepen the campaign’s emotional resonance, Rhode will partner with charitable organizations (MITSloan, 2021) in line with the brands ethos, supporting mental health and self-esteem. Charities may include: National Alliance on Mental Illness (NAMI), Active minds and The Trevor Project. This initiative highlights the campaigns message that glow comes from within and is nurtured by both self-love and community care.

Timeline and rollout

The “What Makes You Glow” campaign will be executed over a four-month timeline, segmented into distinct phases to build anticipation, maximize engagement and sustain momentum.

Pre-Launch (Weeks 1-6)

Objective: Build Excitement and Curiosity

- **Teasers on Social Media:** Share cryptic posts and stories with questions like “What Makes You Glow?” with visuals of light and radiance to spark intrigue.
- **Behind-the-Scenes Content:** Showcase Hailey Bieber and the Rhode team preparing for the campaign, including product photoshoots and snippets of Hailey sharing her glow moments.
- **Influencer Seeding:** Partner with key influencers and send them personalized “What Makes You Glow” packages. Ask them to share their interpretations and tease the upcoming launch
- **Email Campaign:** Send teasers to Rhode’s mailing list with hints about the campaign theme and exclusive early access to the launch.

Launch Phase (Weeks 6-10)

Objective: Announce the campaign and engage audiences across platforms.

- **Campaign Video Launch:** Release a “hero campaign” video featuring Hailey Bieber and a diverse group of individuals sharing their “glow moments,” paired with Rhode products that enhance their glow. The video will be distributed on Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, and Rhode’s website.
- **Social Media Challenges:** Start a *#WhatMakesYouGlow* hashtag challenge on TikTok, encouraging users to share short videos about the little things that make them glow. This may come in the form of photo carousels showcasing intimate moments- sentiment drives engagement on platforms such as TikTok and Instagram.
- **Product Launch:** Introduce limited-edition *Glow Kits*, featuring bundles of Rhode’s core products in special campaign packaging, with messaging that ties skincare to celebrating personal “glow” moments.
- **Influencer Activation:** Collaborate with influencers across different demographics to share their “glow” stories and Rhode skincare routines, tagging the brand and utilizing the brand hashtag.

Community Engagement and Measurement Phase (Weeks 10-12)

- **Pop-Up events:** Host pop-up events in key consumer cities such as: New York, LA and London
- **Virtual Workshops:** conduct live online workshops led by Hailey and dermatologists.
- **Closing Campaign:** Create a video featuring the best of the *#WhatMakesYouGlow* submissions showcasing collective impact.
- **Analytics and Insights:** Track key metrics, including: social media engagement, UGC participation, sales and website traffic
- Share campaign impact in a newsletter to Rhode’s Audience thanking them for their participation.

By focusing on the small, joyful moments that contribute to inner and outer radiance, “What Makes You Glow” aims to shift Rhodes position from a luxury skincare brand to an experience, a partner that aids in helping people feel their best for the moments that matter the most. This human-focused and celebratory approach will strengthen Rhodes dynamic with its audience and reinforce its ethos of effortless, minimalist beauty.

Works Cited

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Appendix:

rhode

DATE

20.12.24

SUBJECT

GLOW 1

RADIANCE

family	3.00
fitness	3.00
peptide glazing fluid	3.50
your bf	4.20
friends	4.50
barrier restore cream	5.25
coffee	4.50

would you like a bag with that?

#whatmakesyoutglow

